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1,300 errant companies fined over Dh34m

ABU DHABI
BY AGHADDIR ALI
Senior Reporter

The Ministry of Human Resources and Emiratisation (MoHRE) is taking tough action against businesses that aren't operating as they should — especially those that keep workers on record without actually giving them real jobs.

Since the beginning of the year, the ministry has identified around 1,300 companies, owned by nearly 1,800 employers, that were not practicing their licensed business activities. These companies had workers registered under their name, even though no actual work was being done.

As a result, the ministry imposed more than Dh34 million in fines, suspended the companies' ability to apply for new work permits, and moved them to the lowest category in the private sector classification system — a status that comes with penalties and tighter restrictions.

Blocking violators

In a broader effort to protect the UAE labour market, MoHRE also blocked the violators from registering new businesses in its system.

MoHRE is urging all business owners to cancel their licenses and properly update their workers' status if their businesses stop operating. Failing to do so could lead to serious legal consequences for both the employer and the workers involved, especially when there is no genuine working relationship.

Joby Aerial Taxi's first test flight a 'major step' towards Dubai launch

DEVELOPED BY CALIFORNIA-BASED JOBY AVIATION, AIRCRAFT TO FLY FROM 2026

DUBAI
BY KHITAM ALAMIR
Chief News Editor

Dubai has successfully conducted the region's first test flight of the Joby Aerial Taxi, marking a significant milestone in the emirate's efforts to redefine urban mobility and integrate cutting-edge, eco-friendly transportation systems.

The announcement was made yesterday by Shaikh Hamdan Bin Mohammad Bin Rashid Al Maktoum, Crown Prince of Dubai, Deputy Prime Minister, Minister of Defence of the UAE, and Chairman of Dubai Executive Council. Taking to his official X account, Shaikh Hamdan described the achievement as a "major step" toward launching full aerial taxi operations next year.

"Dubai has successfully completed the region's first test flight of the Joby Aerial Taxi," he said.

"Conducted through a collaboration between Dubai's Roads and Transport Authority and Joby Aviation, the test flight marks a major step toward launching full operations next year."

A new leap

The all-electric, vertical take-off and landing aircraft — developed by California-based Joby Aviation — promises to slash travel times, reduce emissions, and contribute to a more efficient and sustainable urban transit ecosystem.

Calling it "a new leap in eco-friendly urban mobility," Shaikh Hamdan noted that the initiative supports the UAE's broader vision of becoming a global hub

12 minutes

Travel time from Dubai International Airport to Palm Jumeirah

The all-electric, vertical take-off and landing aircraft promises to slash travel times, reduce emissions, and contribute to a more efficient and sustainable urban transit ecosystem.



for innovation and the adoption of transformative technologies. "Our nation's skies have opened to new possibilities," he said. "And the best is yet to come."

Dubai's embrace of aerial mobility comes as part of a larger strategy to revolutionise transportation, reduce traffic congestion, and position the city at the forefront of next-generation infrastructure and smart city planning.

Mattar Al Tayer, Director General, Chairman of the Board of Executive Directors of Dubai's Roads and Transport Authority (RTA) said, "The aerial taxi will introduce a new premium service for residents and visitors seeking smooth, fast, and safe travel to key destinations across the city. A journey from Dubai International Airport to Palm Jumeirah, for example, is expected to take just 12 minutes,

compared to approximately 45 minutes by car.

"The service will also strengthen integration with public transport systems and individual mobility options such as e-scooters and bicycles, enabling seamless multimodal travel and enhanced connectivity across the city, ensuring a smooth and convenient experience for all passengers."

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Traffic snarls worry UAE commuters

80 per cent of respondents said traffic had worsened compared to 2024

DUBAI
BY ASHWANI KUMAR
Chief Reporter

A new study, commissioned jointly by Road-SafetyUAE and Al Wathba Insurance, showed that 86 per cent of respondents across the UAE face traffic congestion, with 91 per cent of respondents in Dubai and 90 per cent in Sharjah experiencing it.

In addition, 80 per cent of respondents said traffic had

45%
said dependence on
private cars a reason
for traffic congestion

worsened compared to 2024, with 85 per cent in Dubai noticing an increase.

The study surveyed a representative UAE sample of 1,021 respondents this month.

When asked about the causes of traffic congestion, 65 per cent of respondents cited too many vehicles on the road, 54 per cent felt all offices start around the same time, 48 per cent felt all school start

around the same time, while 45 per cent said heavy dependence on private cars is the reason for traffic congestion.

Poor driving behaviour

Additional causes include poor driving behaviour, low vehicle occupancy, limited work-from-home flexibility, and inadequate infrastructure to handle traffic volumes, limited availability of public transport and lack of infrastructure for alternative transport options like walking and biking.

Respondents were also asked to suggest solutions. An overwhelming 83 per cent collectively called for better public transportation options.

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